2021 Vision Quest Ratatouille Recipe

a. 6 large ripe red tomatoes
b. 1 large eggplant, diced into 1-inch cubes
c. 1 large red pepper, cut into 1-inch dice
d. 1 large green pepper, cut into 1-inch dice
e. 1 large zucchini, 1-inch dice
f. 1 large yellow squash, 1-inch dice
g. 5-6 tablespoons Extra Virgin Olive Oil (I used more.)
h. 1 Tablespoon Kosher salt, or more to taste
i. 1 large yellow onion, chopped
j. 4 cloves garlic, pressed or minced
k. 1/4 cup chopped fresh basil
l. 1/4 teaspoon red pepper flakes, more or less to taste
m. 1/4 teaspoon dried oregano
n. Freshly ground black pepper, to taste

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 425◦ with one rack in the middle of the oven and one in the upper third of the oven. Line two large, rimmed baking sheets with parchment paper for easy clean-up, if desired.
2. To prepare your tomatoes, remove any woody cores with a paring knife. Puree the tomatoes in a Vita-Mix or food processor. Set aside.
3. On one baking sheet, toss the diced eggplant with olive oil until lightly coated. Arrange the eggplant in a single layer across the pan, sprinkle with salt, and set aside.
4. On the other baking sheet, toss the bell pepper, zucchini and yellow squash with olive oil and salt. Arrange the vegetables in a single layer. Place the eggplant pan on the middle rack and the other vegetables on the top rack. Roast for 10-15 minutes.
5. Sauté onion in olive oil, stirring occasionally, until the onion is tender and caramelizing on the edges, about 8 to 10 minutes.
6. Add the garlic, stir, and cook until fragrant. Add the tomatoes, and stir any browned bits stuck to the bottom of the pan into the mixture. Reduce the heat and simmer.
7. After 10-15 minutes, remove both pans from the oven, stir the vegetables and roast again, this time place the eggplant on the top rack and other vegetables on the middle rack.
8. Bake until the eggplant is nice and golden on the edges, about 10 more minutes (the eggplant will be done sooner than the rest). Remove the eggplant from the oven, and carefully stir the eggplant into the simmering tomato sauce.
9. Let the squash and bell pepper pan continue to bake until the peppers are caramelized, about 5 more minutes. Then, transfer the contents of the pan into the simmering sauce. Season to taste with oregano, salt and pepper.
10. Before serving add additional olive oil, fresh basil and red pepper flakes (optional). Serve in bowls, perhaps with a little drizzle of olive oil, additional chopped basil, or black pepper on top (all optional). This ratatouille's flavor improves as it cools. It's even better reheated the next day. Ratatouille keeps well in the refrigerator, covered, for 4 days, or for several months in the freezer.